



MoVR System

MIT is currently working on a MoVR System that will make wireless VR possible with any headset. <http://digit.in/movrmit>



A competitor to Slack?

Broadsoft launches Team-One, a business group chatting and productivity application similar to Slack. <http://digit.in/tm1Bs>



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Prasad delivery, live pujas and other ways in which technology is making spirituality more accessible

Religious websites are becoming increasingly popular due to the range of services that they have to offer



Aakriti Thapar

For better or for worse, religion is the central force that many Indians rely on as a way of life. For many Digit readers Technology is their only religion but that doesn't mean conventional religion is not followed by the rest of the population. The religion market in India is estimated to be over \$30 billion according to a figure quoted by the *Times*

Of India a couple of years ago. However, the worth of the market is estimated to be a whopping \$48 billion today. With the coming of the internet and innovative tech startups subsequently, this market is booming even in the technology realm. Religious-tech companies have transcended geographical boundaries and have made paying homage to deities (from a distance) a possibility.

Here's a roundup of a few services on offer:

1) onlineprasad.com

This startup is the brainchild of a BITS Pilani graduate - Goonjan Mall. They offer home delivery of prasad (across the globe) from 50 top temples in the country. You can also skip the queue at the temple by pre-booking your Darshan. From assistance on local spiritual experiences to supplying pooja essentials like Zevotion - rudraksh, idols and posters, Online

Prasad is a one stop portal for all your religious wishes.

Another key feature of this startup is that you can wipe the sins of your ancestors and liberate their souls online, at the cost of ₹600 (we kid you not - that's what the website says). As part of the Brahman Bhoj service, the website will feed the Brahmins on your behalf and send you a report when it is done.

2) shubhkart.com

In addition to offering prasad like Online Prasad, Shubh Kart brands itself as a platform that provides all puja items under one roof. They extend their services beyond Hindu religious



Range of 'party' clutches available on the 'Shubh Kart' website

items by offering options to purchase paraphernalia for the Buddhism way of worship. Extending the 'God is everywhere' concept to practical application, you can now opt for religious home decor. God branded wall-hangings and cushion covers are available on ShubhKart. In the midst of searching for your puja items, don't forget to browse the few ethnic 'party' clutches and handbags available on the website.

3) www.sikhistore.com

Turbans, clothing, greeting cards, accessories; name it and they have it! To top the list, the Sikhi Store has games to offer. The games include jigsaw puzzles of Sikh military commanders and other leaders, as well as a wooden set of Punjabi alphabets. They also offer Sikh books and comics. Sikhi store is based out of Nottingham in the United Kingdom and therefore, they cater to the Indian Sikh community abroad.



Braham Bhoj service on the Online Prasad website